



TYPING IN TRUST? THINK BEFORE YOU PROMPT

Why AI feels private — and why it isn't

"It felt like a one-on-one conversation — until our internal code showed up in a public forum."

AI tools often feel like personal assistants, but many retain and process your inputs. In 2023, Samsung engineers inadvertently leaked sensitive data by inputting confidential information into ChatGPT, leading to a company-wide ban on such tools.

What's at risk when prompts aren't private

Public prompt sharing can lead to unintended data exposure:

- **Confidential information leaks:** Sensitive data entered into AI tools can be stored and potentially accessed by unauthorized parties.
- **Prompt injection attacks:** Malicious actors can manipulate AI behavior through crafted inputs, leading to data exfiltration.
- **Unsecured databases:** Misconfigured AI systems have exposed thousands of user prompts, including explicit content, to the public internet.

How to prompt with privacy in mind

Before sharing prompts publicly or inputting sensitive data into AI tools, consider the following:

- **Review data policies:** Understand how your AI tool stores and uses your data.
- **Avoid sharing confidential information:** Treat AI interactions as public, not private.
- **Use secure platforms:** Opt for AI tools that prioritize data security and offer privacy controls.

▼ BOTTOM LINE:

AI tools are powerful but not inherently private. Always consider the sensitivity of the information you share and choose platforms that prioritize data security.

★ Quick Tips

"Think before you prompt."

Drafting

🔥 **Limit sensitive details:** Avoid inputting confidential information into AI tools.

🔒 **Use placeholders:** Replace sensitive data with generic terms when drafting prompts.

Reviewing

👁️ **Double-check outputs:** Ensure AI responses don't inadvertently include sensitive information.

🗑️ **Clean up drafts:** Remove any confidential data before sharing AI-generated content.

Responsibility

✅ **Understand data policies:** Familiarize yourself with how your AI tool handles data.

🔒 **Choose secure platforms:** Opt for AI tools that prioritize user privacy and data security.

Further Reading:

- [Samsung Engineers Feed Sensitive Data to ChatGPT, Sparking Workplace AI Warnings](#)
- [The quiet data breach hiding in AI workflows](#)
- [AI image generator's data leak exposed thousands of prompts](#)